Helping Verbs at Work

Can

We use “can” to express ability, permission, possibility, requests, offers and suggestions. Let's see all the major uses of “can” with examples.

1. Ability — being able to do something [Meaning: सक्षम होना / कर पाना]
Use “can” when someone has the skill or ability to do something.

- She can speak English.
- I can write code in Go.
- Can you drive a car?

2. Permission — asking or giving permission [Meaning: अनुमति होना / अनुमति देना]
Use “can” to ask whether something is allowed or to allow someone to do it.

- Can I use your laptop?
- You can leave early today.
- You can't enter this room.

3. Possibility — something that may happen [Meaning: संभव होना / हो सकता है]
Use “can” when something is possible, sometimes depending on the situation.

- Traffic can be bad in the evening.
- Learning a new language can be difficult.
- Anyone can make a mistake.

4. Requests — asking someone to do something [Meaning: क्या आप ... कर सकते हैं?]
Use “can” to ask someone to help you or do something.

- Can you help me?
- Can you explain this again?
- Can you send me the file?

5. Offers — offering help or something [Meaning: मैं ... कर सकता हूँ / क्या मैं ... दूँ?]
Use “can” when offering to do something for someone.

- I can help you with this.
- We can pick you up from the station.
- Can I get you a glass of water?

6. Suggestions — proposing an option [Meaning: हम ... कर सकते हैं / आप ... कर सकते हैं]
Use “can” to suggest what someone could do.

- We can go out for dinner.
- You can try restarting your laptop.
- We can discuss this tomorrow.

Could

We use “could” to express past ability, polite requests, polite permission, possibility, suggestions and imagined situations. Let's see all the major uses of “could” with examples.

1. Past ability — what someone was able to do before [Meaning: कर पाता था / कर सकता था]
Use “could” for an ability someone had in the past.

- I could swim when I was five.
- We couldn't find the root cause yesterday.
- He couldn't sleep last night.

2. Polite requests — asking more politely than “can” [Meaning: क्या आप ... कर सकेंगे?]
Use “could” to ask someone to do something in a polite way.

- Could you review my pull request?
- Could you speak a little slower?
- Could you send me the report by Friday?

3. Polite permission — asking if you may do something [Meaning: क्या मैं ... कर सकता हूँ?]
Use “could” to ask for permission politely, especially with seniors or strangers.

- Could I leave a little early today?
- Could I borrow your charger?
- Could I ask you a question?

4. Possibility — something that might happen or be true [Meaning: हो सकता है]
Use “could” when something is possible but not certain.

- It could rain later.
- The issue could be in the database.
- He could be stuck in traffic.

5. Suggestions — proposing an idea softly [Meaning: हम ... कर सकते हैं]
Use “could” to suggest an idea without pushing it.

- We could order pizza tonight.
- You could try clearing the cache.
- We could ask the platform team.

6. Imagined situations — what would be possible if things were different [Meaning: अगर ... तो ... कर पाता]
Use “could” with “if” for situations that are not real.

- If I had more time, I could learn the guitar.
- If we had the logs, we could fix it faster.
- I could buy a house if I saved more.

7. Past possibility (could have) — something that was possible but did not happen [Meaning: ... कर सकते थे / हो सकता था]
Use “could have” for a chance that existed in the past but was not taken.

- You could have called me.
- We could have caught this bug in testing.
- It could have been worse.

Will

We use “will” to talk about the future, decisions made while speaking, promises, offers, predictions, requests and refusals. Let's see all the major uses of “will” with examples.

1. Future facts — things that are going to happen [Meaning: ... होगा / करेगा]
Use “will” for things that will happen in the future.

- The release will go out on Thursday.
- I will be 30 next year.
- The store will open at 10.

2. Instant decisions — deciding while speaking [Meaning: अभी तय किया — मैं ... कर देता हूँ]
Use “will” when you decide something at the moment of speaking.

- I'll take that ticket.
- It's cold, I'll close the window.
- I'll have a coffee, please.

3. Promises — saying you will definitely do something [Meaning: वादा करना]
Use “will” to promise something.

- I'll send you the invoice tonight.
- I won't tell anyone.
- I'll call you when I get home.

4. Offers — offering to help [Meaning: मैं ... कर दूँगा]
Use “will” to offer help in a direct, friendly way.

- I'll help you with the migration.
- I'll get the door for you.
- I'll drop you at the station.

5. Predictions — what you think will happen [Meaning: अंदाज़ा — ... होगा]
Use “will” to say what you believe will happen.

- This change will break the build.
- You'll love this place.
- It will probably rain tomorrow.

6. Requests — asking someone to do something [Meaning: क्या आप ... करेंगे?]
Use “will” to ask someone directly to do something.

- Will you join the call at 4?
- Will you please close the door?
- Will you marry me?

7. Refusals (won't) — something does not work or someone refuses [Meaning: नहीं करेगा / चल ही नहीं रहा]
Use “won't” when something refuses to work or someone refuses to do something.

- The car won't start.
- He won't listen.
- The app won't load on my phone.

Would

We use “would” for polite requests and offers, imagined situations, preferences, past habits, future in the past and soft opinions. Let's see all the major uses of “would” with examples.

1. Polite requests — the most polite way to ask [Meaning: क्या आप ... करेंगे?]
Use “would” to ask someone to do something very politely.

- Would you mind sharing the design doc?
- Would you turn down the music, please?
- Would you be able to review this today?

2. Offers and invitations — offering something politely [Meaning: क्या आप ... लेंगे?]
Use “would you like” to offer something or invite someone.

- Would you like some tea?
- Would you like to join us for dinner?
- Would it help if I joined the call?

3. Imagined situations — what would happen if something were true [Meaning: अगर ... तो ... करता]
Use “would” with “if” for situations that are not real now.

- If I won the lottery, I would travel the world.
- If I were in your place, I would take the job.
- That would break the existing API.

4. Imagined past (would have) — what would have happened [Meaning: ... कर देता / हो जाता]
Use “would have” for a past result that did not happen.

- I would have come, but I was sick.
- We would have missed the deadline without your help.
- She would have loved this.

5. Preferences — what you want or like more [Meaning: पसंद करूँगा / चाहूँगा]
Use “would like”, “would rather” or “would prefer” to say what you want.

- I would like a window seat.
- I'd rather stay home tonight.
- I would prefer to do this after the release.

6. Past habits — things you did regularly in the past [Meaning: पहले ... करता था]
Use “would” for something you did again and again in the past.

- When I was a kid, I would play cricket every evening.
- We would deploy manually every Friday.
- My grandfather would tell us stories at night.

7. Future in the past — reporting what someone said about the future [Meaning: कहा था कि ... करेगा]
Use “would” when you report a past statement about the future.

- He said he would call back.
- I knew it would work.
- She promised she would come.

8. Soft opinions — giving an opinion politely [Meaning: मेरे ख़याल से]
Use “would” to make an opinion sound softer.

- I would say we should wait.
- I wouldn't worry about it.
- I would think it's fine.

Shall

We use “shall” to make offers, suggestions and formal rules, and to ask what to do. It is mostly used with “I” and “we”, and it sounds formal in American English. Let's see all the major uses of “shall” with examples.

1. Offers — offering to do something [Meaning: क्या मैं ... कर दूँ?]
Use “Shall I...?” to offer help.

- Shall I close the curtains?
- Shall I take the notes?
- Shall I book a cab for you?

2. Suggestions — proposing something together [Meaning: क्या हम ... करें?]
Use “Shall we...?” to suggest doing something together.

- Shall we start the meeting?
- Shall we go for a walk?
- Shall we order lunch?

3. Asking for a decision — asking what to do [Meaning: मैं क्या करूँ? / हम कहाँ ... करें?]
Use “shall” with a question word when you want the other person to decide.

- What shall I wear tonight?
- Where shall we meet?
- Which one shall I pick?

4. Formal rules — duties in contracts and specifications [Meaning: ... करना अनिवार्य होगा]
Use “shall” in legal or technical documents to state a rule that must be followed.

- The tenant shall pay rent by the 5th of every month.
- The system shall log every login attempt.
- Each party shall keep this information confidential.

5. Strong intention — a firm promise, in formal speech [Meaning: ज़रूर ... करूँगा]
Use “shall” to sound determined, mostly in speeches and formal writing.

- We shall overcome.
- I shall return.
- You shall have my answer by Monday.

Should

We use “should” to give advice, talk about duty, say what we expect, ask for advice, express regret and state formal conditions. Let's see all the major uses of “should” with examples.

1. Advice — telling someone what is a good idea [Meaning: ... करना चाहिए]
Use “should” to suggest the right thing to do.

- You should see a doctor.
- You should add a test for this.
- You should take a break.

2. Duty — what is right or expected [Meaning: ... करना चाहिए (फ़र्ज़)]
Use “should” for what people are expected to do.

- We should respect our elders.
- Everyone should wear a seatbelt.
- Code should be reviewed before merging.

3. Expectation — what you expect to be true or happen [Meaning: ... होना चाहिए / उम्मीद है]
Use “should” when you expect something because it is normal or planned.

- The build should finish in ten minutes.
- He should be home by now.
- This should fix the issue.

4. Asking for advice — Should I...? [Meaning: क्या मुझे ... करना चाहिए?]
Use “should” in a question to ask someone's opinion.

- Should I call him?
- Should we wait for QA?
- What should I say to the client?

5. Regret and criticism (should have) — something that did not happen [Meaning: ... करना चाहिए था]
Use “should have” for a past mistake or a better choice that was not made.

- I should have left earlier.
- We should have tested this on staging.
- You shouldn't have shouted at him.

6. Formal conditions — “should” in place of “if” [Meaning: अगर ... हो तो]
Use “should” at the start of a sentence in formal writing to mean “if”.

- Should you need anything, let me know.
- Should the payment fail, the system will retry.
- Should you have questions, email the support team.

Must

We use “must” for strong obligation, personal necessity, prohibition, logical certainty and strong recommendations. Let's see all the major uses of “must” with examples.

1. Strong obligation — rules and requirements [Meaning: ... करना ही होगा / ज़रूरी है]
Use “must” for rules and laws that leave no choice.

- All API calls must use HTTPS.
- You must wear a helmet on a bike.
- Passengers must show their ticket.

2. Personal necessity — what the speaker feels is necessary [Meaning: मुझे ... करना ही है]
Use “must” when you yourself feel something is important to do.

- I must call my mother today.
- I must finish this before I leave.
- We must meet again soon.

3. Prohibition (must not) — something that is not allowed [Meaning: ... करना मना है]
Use “must not” or “mustn't” when something is forbidden.

- You must not share your password.
- Visitors must not smoke here.
- We mustn't deploy on Friday evening.

4. Logical certainty — a strong guess from evidence [Meaning: ज़रूर ... होगा]
Use “must” when you are almost sure something is true.

- He must be tired after the trip.
- The config must be wrong.
- She must be in a meeting.

5. Past certainty (must have) — a strong guess about the past [Meaning: ज़रूर ... हुआ होगा]
Use “must have” when you are almost sure something happened.

- I must have left my keys at home.
- Someone must have changed the config.
- It must have rained last night.

6. Strong recommendation — something you think is very good [Meaning: ज़रूर ... करना]
Use “must” to recommend something with enthusiasm.

- You must try the biryani here.
- You must watch this film.
- You must visit Jaipur in winter.

May

We use “may” to talk about possibility, to ask for and give permission formally, to make polite offers, to express wishes and to accept a point before disagreeing. Let's see all the major uses of “may” with examples.

1. Possibility — something that is possible [Meaning: शायद ... हो / हो सकता है]
Use “may” when something is possible and fairly likely.

- The release may slip to next sprint.
- It may rain this evening.
- He may be late today.

2. Formal permission — asking for permission politely [Meaning: क्या मैं ... कर सकता हूँ?]
Use “May I...?” in formal situations, such as interviews, client calls and meetings.

- May I come in?
- May I add one point here?
- May I ask who is calling?

3. Giving permission — formally allowing something [Meaning: आप ... कर सकते हैं]
Use “may” in notices, rules and formal speech to say something is allowed.

- You may leave once you finish the test.
- Guests may use the pool until 10 pm.
- You may start now.

4. Polite offers — offering help formally [Meaning: क्या मैं ... कर दूँ?]
Use “May I...?” to offer help in a very polite way.

- May I help you?
- May I take your coat?
- May I get you something to drink?

5. Wishes — hoping something good happens [Meaning: ऐसा हो कि / भगवान करे]
Use “may” at the start of a sentence for wishes and blessings.

- May you live long.
- May all your dreams come true.
- May the best team win.

6. Accepting a point (may ... but) — before disagreeing politely [Meaning: हो सकता है ..., पर]
Use “may ... but” to accept what someone says and then give your view.

- That may be true, but the latency is still high.
- He may be young, but he is very skilled.
- It may look simple, but it took weeks.

7. Past possibility (may have) — something that possibly happened [Meaning: शायद ... हुआ हो]
Use “may have” when something possibly happened in the past.

- I may have deleted the file by mistake.
- She may have missed the train.
- The email may have gone to spam.

Might

We use “might” for a smaller possibility than “may”, for soft suggestions, polite questions, past possibility and the past form of “may” in reported speech. Let's see all the major uses of “might” with examples.

1. Possibility — something that is possible but less likely [Meaning: शायद ... हो (कम संभावना)]
Use “might” when something is possible but you are not very sure.

- I might need help with the setup.
- We might go to Goa this winter.
- It might not work on older phones.

2. Soft suggestions — suggesting something gently [Meaning: शायद ... करना ठीक रहे]
Use “might want to” or “might like to” to suggest something without pressure.

- You might want to check the logs first.
- You might like this book.
- We might try a different approach.

3. Polite disagreement — saying something carefully [Meaning: शायद हम ...]
Use “might” to question an idea without sounding rude.

- We might be solving the wrong problem here.
- That might not be the best time to call.
- You might be right, but let's test it first.

4. Past possibility (might have) — something that possibly happened [Meaning: शायद ... हुआ हो]
Use “might have” when you are not sure what happened.

- He might have forgotten about the meeting.
- I might have left my wallet in the cab.
- The server might have restarted at night.

5. Missed possibility (might have) — something that could have happened but did not [Meaning: ... हो सकता था]
Use “might have” for a result that was possible but did not happen.

- You might have told me earlier.
- We might have won if it hadn't rained.
- That mistake might have cost us the client.

6. Reported speech — the past form of “may” [Meaning: कहा था कि शायद ...]
Use “might” when you report something that someone said with “may”.

- She said she might be late.
- He told me he might join the team.
- They said the flight might be delayed.

Ought to

We use “ought to” to give advice, talk about moral duty, say what we expect, and express regret about the past. It means almost the same as “should” but sounds a little more formal. Let's see all the major uses of “ought to” with examples.

1. Advice — what is a good idea [Meaning: ... करना चाहिए]
Use “ought to” to give advice, just like “should”.

- You ought to rest for a few days.
- You ought to back up your data.
- We ought to leave before the traffic starts.

2. Moral duty — what is the right thing to do [Meaning: ... करना चाहिए (सही यही है)]
Use “ought to” when something is the right or fair thing to do.

- You ought to apologize to her.
- We ought to help our neighbors.
- Companies ought to pay people on time.

3. Expectation — what should happen if all goes normally [Meaning: ... होना चाहिए]
Use “ought to” when you expect something to be true or to happen.

- The package ought to arrive tomorrow.
- This ought to be enough for the trip.
- The new server ought to handle the load.

4. Past regret (ought to have) — something that should have happened [Meaning: ... करना चाहिए था]
Use “ought to have” for a past duty or a better choice that was not made.

- I ought to have called you.
- They ought to have warned us.
- We ought to have planned this better.

5. Negative form (ought not to) — what is not right to do [Meaning: ... नहीं करना चाहिए]
Use “ought not to” to say something is wrong or unwise. It is formal; in speech “shouldn't” is more common.

- You ought not to drive so fast.
- We ought not to ignore these warnings.
- He ought not to speak to customers like that.

Do, Does and Did

We use “do”, “does” and “did” to make questions, negatives, emphasis, short answers and question tags, and to avoid repeating a verb. Use “do” with I, you, we and they, “does” with he, she and it, and “did” for the past with every subject. After all three, the main verb stays in its base form. Let's see all the major uses with examples.

1. Questions — asking yes or no questions [Meaning: क्या ...?]
Use “do”, “does” or “did” at the start of a question.

- Do you have access to the dashboard?
- Does this need a code review?
- Did you push the change?

2. Negatives — saying something is not true [Meaning: नहीं]
Use “don't”, “doesn't” or “didn't” before the main verb.

- I don't agree with this approach.
- It doesn't work on staging.
- We didn't get any alert.

3. Emphasis — insisting that something is true [Meaning: सच में / तो]
Use “do”, “does” or “did” in a positive sentence when someone doubts you.

- I did send the email yesterday.
- It does work, but only on Chrome.
- I do like your idea.

4. Short answers — answering without repeating the sentence [Meaning: हाँ, ... / नहीं, ...]
Use “do”, “does” or “did” to give a short reply to a question.

- “Do you have the logs?” “Yes, I do.”
- “Did the test pass?” “No, it didn't.”
- “Does he know?” “Yes, he does.”

5. Question tags — checking something at the end of a sentence [Meaning: है ना? / किया था ना?]
Use “don't”, “doesn't” or “didn't” at the end of a positive sentence to ask for agreement.

- You work here, don't you?
- She lives in Pune, doesn't she?
- You called him, didn't you?

6. Avoiding repetition — replacing a verb already used [Meaning: मैं भी / वैसे ही]
Use “do”, “does” or “did” in place of a verb that was just mentioned.

- She likes coffee, and so do I.
- He didn't finish, and neither did I.
- I work longer hours than he does.

7. Warm requests — inviting or encouraging strongly [Meaning: ज़रूर ...]
Use “do” before a request to make it warm and sincere.

- Do come to the party.
- Do let me know when you're in town.
- Do take care.

8. “Do” as the main verb — doing an action [Meaning: करना]
Use “do” as the main verb as well as the helping verb when the action itself is “do”.

- What do you do for a living?
- Did you do the review?
- He does the dishes every night.

Have, Has and Had

We use “have”, “has” and “had” to form the perfect tenses, to talk about experience and recent news, to give warnings, to get things done by others and to show possession. Use “have” with I, you, we and they, “has” with he, she and it, and “had” for the past with every subject. Let's see all the major uses with examples.

1. Finished actions — done, with a result now [Meaning: ... कर चुका है / कर दिया है]
Use “have” or “has” with the past participle for an action that is complete and matters now.

- I have pushed the fix.
- She has finished the report.
- We have already eaten.

2. Experience — things done at some time in life [Meaning: कभी ... किया है?]
Use “have” or “has” with “ever” and “never” to talk about life experience.

- Have you ever been to Japan?
- I have never seen snow.
- He has worked with Kafka before.

3. Recent news — just, already and yet [Meaning: अभी-अभी / अभी तक नहीं]
Use “have” or “has” with “just”, “already” or “yet” for things that happened very recently or not yet.

- I have just sent the invite.
- Has the build finished yet?
- They haven't replied yet.

4. Actions still going on — have been + -ing [Meaning: ... से कर रहा है]
Use “have been” or “has been” with an -ing verb for something that started in the past and is still happening.

- We have been waiting for an hour.
- It has been raining since morning.
- How long have you been learning English?

5. The earlier past — had + past participle [Meaning: उससे पहले ही ... हो चुका था]
Use “had” to show which of two past actions happened first.

- When I reached the station, the train had left.
- The meeting had already started when I joined.
- The bug had existed for months before we found it.

6. Long actions before a past moment — had been + -ing [Meaning: तब तक ... से कर रहा था]
Use “had been” with an -ing verb for something that continued up to a point in the past.

- I had been driving for six hours when the car broke down.
- They had been working all night.
- It had been raining, so the roads were wet.

7. Imagined past — if + had [Meaning: अगर ... किया होता]
Use “had” after “if” for a past situation that did not happen.

- If we had started earlier, we would have finished.
- If she had asked, I would have helped.
- Had I known, I would have come.

8. Warnings — had better [Meaning: बेहतर होगा कि ...]
Use “had better” (often “'d better”) to warn that something bad will happen otherwise.

- You'd better leave now, or you'll miss the bus.
- We had better fix this before the demo.
- You'd better not tell him.

9. Getting something done — have + object + past participle [Meaning: ... करवाना]
Use “have something done” when someone else does the work for you.

- I'm having my house painted.
- We had the AC repaired yesterday.
- She has her hair cut every month.

10. “Have” as the main verb — possession, meals and experiences [Meaning: पास होना / खाना / बिताना]
Use “have” as the main verb to say what someone owns, eats or experiences. “Have got” means the same and is common in speech.

- I have two brothers.
- Let's have lunch.
- I've got a meeting at 3.

Am, Is, Are, Was and Were

We use “am”, “is”, “are”, “was” and “were” to describe things, to show actions in progress, to talk about fixed plans, to form the passive, to say what exists and to imagine situations. Use “am” with I, “is” with he, she and it, and “are” with you, we and they. In the past, use “was” with I, he, she and it, and “were” with you, we and they. Let's see all the major uses with examples.

1. Describing — who or what something is [Meaning: है / था]
Use these forms as the main verb to give a name, job, age, quality or feeling.

- I am a software engineer.
- The office is closed today.
- They were very happy with the result.

2. Actions happening now — am, is, are + -ing [Meaning: ... रहा है]
Use “am”, “is” or “are” with an -ing verb for something in progress right now.

- I am working on the bug.
- She is talking to the client.
- They are waiting outside.

3. Actions in progress in the past — was, were + -ing [Meaning: ... रहा था]
Use “was” or “were” with an -ing verb for something that was going on at a past moment.

- I was reading when you called.
- We were having lunch at 2.
- It was raining all day.

4. Fixed plans — am, is, are + -ing for the future [Meaning: ... करने वाला हूँ (तय है)]
Use “am”, “is” or “are” with an -ing verb for future plans that are already arranged.

- I am meeting the client tomorrow.
- We are flying to Delhi on Friday.
- She is joining the team next week.

5. Passive voice — when the action matters more than who did it [Meaning: ... किया जाता है / किया गया]
Use these forms with the past participle when the doer is unknown or not important.

- The report is generated every night.
- The meeting was cancelled.
- These phones are made in India.

6. Saying what exists — there is, there are, there was [Meaning: ... है / ... था (मौजूद)]
Use “there is”, “there are”, “there was” or “there were” to say that something exists or happened.

- There is a problem with the build.
- There are three people waiting for you.
- There was a lot of traffic this morning.

7. Imagined situations — were after if and wish [Meaning: काश ... होता / अगर ... होता]
Use “were” with every subject, including I, he and she, for situations that are not real.

- I wish it were Friday.
- If she were here, she would know the answer.
- If this were easy, everyone would do it.

8. Formal arrangements — be + to [Meaning: ... करना है (तय हुआ है)]
Use “is to”, “are to” or “was to” in formal English for official plans and instructions.

- The CEO is to visit our office next week.
- You are to report to HR on Monday.
- The results were to be announced today.

9. Short answers and question tags — replying and checking [Meaning: हाँ, है / है ना?]
Use these forms to answer briefly or to ask for agreement at the end of a sentence.

- “Is it ready?” “Yes, it is.”
- You are coming tonight, aren't you?
- He was at the meeting, wasn't he?

Need

We use “need” to say what is required, to say something is not necessary, to ask formal questions and to say something requires an action. The form “need to” is covered with “have to” later in this note. Let's see all the other major uses of “need” with examples.

1. Requirements — need + noun [Meaning: ... चाहिए]
Use “need” as the main verb when you require something.

- I need a break.
- We need more time.
- Do you need anything?

2. No necessity — needn't [Meaning: ... करने की ज़रूरत नहीं]
Use “needn't” to say something is not necessary. It sounds a little formal.

- You needn't come tomorrow.
- You needn't worry.
- We needn't wait for him.

3. Formal questions — Need I...? [Meaning: क्या मुझे ... करना होगा?]
Use “need” at the start of a question in formal or dramatic speech.

- Need I say more?
- Need I remind you of the deadline?
- Need we invite everyone?

4. Unnecessary past actions — needn't have [Meaning: ... करने की ज़रूरत नहीं थी (फिर भी किया)]
Use “needn't have” for something that was done but turned out to be unnecessary.

- You needn't have bought a gift.
- I needn't have hurried; the meeting was postponed.
- We needn't have worried.

5. Something requires an action — need + -ing [Meaning: ... करने की ज़रूरत है]
Use “need” with an -ing verb, or with “to be” and a past participle, when a thing needs work done on it.

- The car needs washing.
- This code needs refactoring.
- The plants need to be watered.

Dare

We use “dare” to challenge someone, to show anger, to talk about courage and, in formal speech, to say what we think is likely. Let's see all the major uses of “dare” with examples.

1. Challenges — I dare you to... [Meaning: हिम्मत है तो ... करके दिखाओ]
Use “I dare you to” to challenge someone to do something risky.

- I dare you to jump into the pool.
- I dare you to ask her out.
- I dare you to eat that chilli.

2. Anger and warnings — How dare you / Don't you dare [Meaning: तुम्हारी हिम्मत कैसे हुई / ख़बरदार]
Use “How dare” when you are angry at someone, and “Don't you dare” to warn them.

- How dare you speak to me like that!
- How dare he blame me!
- Don't you dare touch my phone.

3. Courage — dare to, didn't dare to [Meaning: हिम्मत करना / हिम्मत नहीं हुई]
Use “dare” to talk about having or not having the courage to do something.

- I didn't dare to tell my boss.
- Nobody dared to ask the question.
- She dared not look at him.

4. I dare say — I think it is likely [Meaning: मेरे ख़याल से / शायद]
Use “I dare say” in formal or British English to mean “I think” or “probably”.

- I dare say you're right.
- I dare say the traffic will be bad.
- I dare say he knows more than he admits.

Used to

We use “used to” for past habits and past states that are no longer true. We also use “be used to” and “get used to” to talk about being familiar with something. Let's see all the major uses with examples.

1. Past habits — things you did regularly but don't now [Meaning: पहले ... करता था]
Use “used to” with a base verb for a repeated action in the past that has stopped.

- I used to play the guitar.
- We used to live in Pune.
- She used to work at Infosys.

2. Past states — things that were true but are not now [Meaning: पहले ... था]
Use “used to” for situations or facts that have changed.

- There used to be a cinema here.
- He used to be shy.
- This road used to be quiet.

3. Questions and negatives — did ... use to [Meaning: क्या पहले ...? / पहले ... नहीं]
Use “did” with “use to” (without the -d) in questions and negatives.

- Did you use to play cricket?
- Where did you use to live?
- I didn't use to like coffee.

4. Being familiar — be used to + noun or -ing [Meaning: आदत होना]
Use “be used to” (am, is or are used to) for something that is normal for you now.

- I am used to working late.
- She is used to the cold.
- We aren't used to this new tool yet.

5. Becoming familiar — get used to + noun or -ing [Meaning: आदत पड़ना / आदत डालना]
Use “get used to” for the process of something becoming normal.

- You'll get used to the traffic.
- It took me a month to get used to the new laptop.
- I can't get used to waking up early.

Be able to

We use “be able to” for ability in tenses where “can” cannot be used, for success on one occasion in the past, and after other verbs. Let's see all the major uses of “be able to” with examples.

1. Future ability — will be able to [Meaning: कर पाऊँगा]
Use “will be able to”, because “can” has no future form.

- I will be able to finish it by Friday.
- You'll be able to walk again in a week.
- Will you be able to come to the wedding?

2. Success on one occasion — was able to [Meaning: (उस बार) कर पाया]
Use “was able to” or “were able to” when someone managed to do something once in the past.

- I was able to fix the bug last night.
- She was able to catch the last train.
- We were able to save most of the data.

3. After other helping verbs — should, might, have been able to [Meaning: ... कर पाना]
Use “be able to” after another helping verb, where “can” is not possible.

- I should be able to send it by evening.
- We might be able to help.
- I haven't been able to sleep well this week.

4. After “to” and in -ing form — to be able to, being able to [Meaning: ... कर पाना]
Use “be able to” after verbs like “want” and “love”, or as “being able to”.

- I want to be able to speak French.
- I'd love to be able to play the piano.
- Being able to work from home helps a lot.

5. Not able to — not able to, unable to [Meaning: नहीं कर पाया / नहीं कर सकता]
Use “not able to” or the more formal “unable to” when someone cannot do something.

- I wasn't able to attend the call.
- He is unable to travel this month.
- We weren't able to find a parking spot.

Have to, Has to and Had to

We use “have to”, “has to” and “had to” for obligations that come from outside, such as rules, other people or circumstances, and to say something is certainly true. Use “have to” with I, you, we and they, “has to” with he, she and it, and “had to” for the past. Let's see all the major uses with examples.

1. Present obligation — rules and circumstances [Meaning: ... करना पड़ता है / करना है]
Use “have to” or “has to” when something is required by a rule or a situation.

- I have to wear a badge at work.
- She has to submit the report by Monday.
- We have to renew our passports.

2. Past obligation — had to [Meaning: ... करना पड़ा]
Use “had to” for something that was necessary in the past.

- I had to wait two hours at the airport.
- We had to cancel the trip.
- He had to work on Sunday.

3. Future obligation — will have to [Meaning: ... करना पड़ेगा]
Use “will have to” for something that will be necessary.

- You'll have to show your ID at the gate.
- We'll have to start early tomorrow.
- She will have to take an entrance test.

4. No obligation — don't have to [Meaning: ... करने की ज़रूरत नहीं (मनाही नहीं)]
Use “don't have to”, “doesn't have to” or “didn't have to” when something is not necessary. It does not mean “not allowed”.

- You don't have to come if you're busy.
- He doesn't have to pay for this.
- We didn't have to wait long.

5. Questions — Do I have to...? [Meaning: क्या ... करना पड़ेगा?]
Use “do”, “does” or “did” with “have to” to ask about obligation.

- Do I have to sign this form?
- Does she have to work tomorrow?
- Did you have to pay extra?

6. Certainty — has to be [Meaning: ज़रूर ... होगा]
Use “has to be” or “have to be” when you are sure something is true.

- This has to be a mistake.
- He has to be joking.
- That has to be the best pizza in town.

Need to

We use “need to” to say something is necessary, to ask about necessity, and to say something is not necessary, in the present, past and future. Let's see all the major uses of “need to” with examples.

1. Necessity — need to [Meaning: ... करना ज़रूरी है]
Use “need to” when something is important or necessary to do.

- I need to pick up my kids at 5.
- We need to talk.
- You need to update the app.

2. Asking about necessity — Do I need to...? [Meaning: क्या मुझे ... करना होगा?]
Use “do” or “does” with “need to” to ask whether something is necessary.

- Do I need to bring anything?
- Do we need to book in advance?
- Does he need to be on the call?

3. No necessity — don't need to [Meaning: ... करने की ज़रूरत नहीं]
Use “don't need to”, “doesn't need to” or “didn't need to” when something is not necessary.

- You don't need to apologize.
- We don't need to decide today.
- She didn't need to come in on Saturday.

4. Past necessity — needed to [Meaning: ... करना ज़रूरी था]
Use “needed to” for something that was necessary in the past.

- I needed to talk to someone.
- We needed to finish before the client call.
- He needed to rest after the surgery.

5. Future necessity — will need to [Meaning: ... करना पड़ेगा]
Use “will need to” for something that will be necessary later.

- You'll need to reset your password.
- We'll need to hire two more people.
- You'll need to apply for a visa.

Be going to

We use “be going to” for plans already decided, predictions based on what we can see, past plans that changed, questions about plans and firm intentions. Let's see all the major uses of “be going to” with examples.

1. Plans — decided before speaking [Meaning: ... करने वाला हूँ (पहले से तय)]
Use “am, is or are going to” for something you have already decided to do.

- I'm going to buy a new phone.
- We're going to refactor this module next sprint.
- She's going to visit her parents next week.

2. Predictions from evidence — what you can see coming [Meaning: ... होने वाला है (दिख रहा है)]
Use “going to” when something in the present shows what will happen.

- Look at those clouds, it's going to rain.
- The tests are going to fail with this change.
- He's going to be late again.

3. Past plans that changed — was going to [Meaning: ... करने वाला था]
Use “was going to” or “were going to” for a plan that did not happen.

- I was going to call you, but I forgot.
- We were going to launch in May.
- She was going to quit, but she stayed.

4. Questions about plans — Are you going to...? [Meaning: क्या ... करने वाले हो?]
Use “going to” in questions to ask about someone's plans.

- Are you going to join the party?
- What are you going to do this weekend?
- When are they going to announce the results?

5. Firm intentions and warnings [Meaning: ... करके रहूँगा / ... पछताओगे]
Use “going to” to show strong determination or to warn about a result.

- I'm not going to give up.
- I'm going to fix this today, no matter what.
- You're going to regret this.